BrightPath Tech

Technical and Commercial Proposal

Response to RFP MRWB-2026-014: Customer Service and Billing Platform Modernisation

Issued by: Meridian Regional Water Board (fictional)

Submitted: 2026-10-18

Item	Detail
Bidder	BrightPath Tech LLP, Hyderabad, India
Proposed solution	QuickBill low-code billing platform with customer portal
Contract duration	16 weeks
Total 3-year cost	INR 6.04 Cr (indicative)

This is a fictional proposal created for a classroom exercise. All organisations, people and figures are invented.

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1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

BrightPath Tech is a fast-growing digital agency offering the most cost-effective route to a modern billing and customer service experience for the Meridian Regional Water Board. We can deliver a working platform in just 16 weeks at a total three-year cost under INR 7 crore.

We are a young company founded in 2022 and bring energy, speed and modern tooling to every project. Our team of 28 people is based in Hyderabad and works closely with clients using weekly demonstrations.

We understand the Board wants a new billing system and a customer portal so customers can pay bills online and raise complaints. We also understand that the Board would like to move away from its older system and offer a better experience to customers. We have worked with many clients who wanted to modernise quickly and we know how to keep projects simple.

Our approach is to start with what the Board already has, keep changes small and get something live as soon as possible. Additional features can be added after go-live as the Board's needs become clearer.

- Lowest price among the options the Board is likely to receive.
- Fastest delivery: 16 weeks from contract signature to go-live.
- Modern, mobile-friendly customer experience.
- Friendly, flexible team that welcomes feedback.

Our story

BrightPath Tech began in 2022 in a rented room in Hyderabad with three friends, two laptops and a shared belief that technology should be simple, beautiful and fast. Since then we have grown into a team of 28 passionate digital craftspeople. We have never been afraid of a challenge, and we believe that every challenge is simply an opportunity in disguise. Our founders left larger consulting firms because they felt that big projects had become slow, heavy and expensive. We set out to prove that there is a better way.

Today we help clients across retail, education and services to put their ideas online. We love what we do, and our clients tell us that they love working with us because we listen, we move quickly and we are always available on a messaging app when they need us.

Our vision, mission and values

Statement	What it means to us
Vision	To be the most loved digital partner for every organisation that wants to serve its customers better
Mission	To make powerful technology simple, affordable and delightful for everyone
Value: Speed	We believe a good solution delivered quickly is better than a perfect solution delivered late
Value: Simplicity	We remove complexity wherever we can and focus on what matters
Value: Care	We treat every client project as if it were our own business
Value: Curiosity	We keep learning and trying new tools so our clients benefit from the latest ideas

Why the Board should choose BrightPath

Choosing a partner is about more than a price list. It is about energy, attitude and trust. Large, established vendors may bring long lists of credentials, but they also bring long timelines, long meetings and long invoices. BrightPath offers the Board something different: a nimble team that can start immediately, work side by side with your people and put a modern customer experience in front of your customers within one quarter. We believe the Board's customers deserve a digital experience as good as the best consumer apps they use every day, and we are excited to make that happen.

We also believe in transparency. We will always tell you what is going well and what is not, and we will never hide behind jargon. If something is difficult, we will say so and work with you to find a way forward.

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

We will customise our low-code platform, QuickBill, which provides billing, payments and a simple customer portal. The portal will be mobile friendly. QuickBill runs on a single cloud server which can be upgraded if more capacity is needed.

QuickBill was first released in 2024 and is used by two small clients for subscription billing. The platform lets our developers build screens and billing rules quickly without writing much code. For the Board we will configure water tariffs, bill generation and online payment.

Component	Description
Billing module	Generates monthly bills from meter readings using configured tariff slabs
Customer portal	Web portal where customers can view bills, pay online and submit complaints
Payments	Integration with a standard online payment gateway
Admin screens	Basic screens for staff to look up accounts and update details
Hosting	Single cloud server in India with daily backups

The platform can handle the Board's customers. Exact performance figures will be measured during testing. If the number of users grows, the server size can be increased.

Customer experience

The portal will have a clean, modern look and will work on phones and desktops. Customers can see their latest bill, download a PDF copy, pay online and report an issue. Language support will be decided with the Board later.

Technology approach

QuickBill is built on modern, widely used web technologies and is designed to be flexible. The look and feel can be adapted to the Board's branding, and screens can be rearranged by our developers in a matter of hours. Because the platform is low-code, many changes that would take weeks on a traditional system can be made in days. We believe that this agility is a key advantage for an organisation that wants to improve continually.

Feature	Benefit to the Board
Drag-and-drop screen builder	Faster changes and lower cost
Reusable billing templates	Quicker setup of tariffs and bill formats

Feature	Benefit to the Board
Responsive design	Works well on phones, tablets and computers
Cloud hosting	No servers to buy or maintain
Dashboard widgets	Simple visual summaries of bills and payments
Modern payment options	Customers can pay in a way that suits them

Future roadmap (aspirational)

Beyond the first release we hope to explore a number of exciting opportunities together with the Board. These ideas are part of our vision for the platform and will be prioritised based on the Board's feedback and our available capacity.

- Artificial intelligence assistant to answer common customer questions.
- Predictive analytics to help the Board understand consumption trends.
- Chat-based bill payments through popular messaging applications.
- Smart alerts for unusual water usage that may indicate leaks.
- A community feature where customers can share water-saving tips.
- Exploration of blockchain for tamper-proof records, if the Board is interested.

Timelines for these items have not been fixed, and they are not included in the price or in the 16-week plan.

Scalability and performance

We are confident that QuickBill will perform well for the Board. The platform has been designed with growth in mind, and we will monitor performance and increase resources when needed. Our approach to performance is to start small, measure and improve. We do not currently have performance test results for volumes similar to the Board's customer base, but we will carry out testing before go-live if time permits.

3. Integration Approach

Integration with the finance system will be done through file exports. Other integrations will be discussed after contract award.

For meter readings, the Board's team can send us a file of readings every month which we will upload into QuickBill. We may look at connecting directly to the meter system in a later phase.

System	Approach
Finance system (SAP)	Monthly file export
Meter data system	To be discussed after contract award
Payment gateway	Standard plug-in

Our philosophy on integration

Modern organisations rely on many systems, and we believe that systems should work together smoothly. Our philosophy is to keep integrations simple and to avoid unnecessary complexity. File-based exchange has been used successfully by businesses for many years and it is easy to understand, easy to support and easy to change. Where the Board wishes to move to real-time connections, we will be happy to discuss options once the first release is live and the team has had the opportunity to learn from real usage.

We have a flexible mindset and enjoy working with other vendors' teams. We expect that the Board's finance and meter systems vendors will cooperate to share the information we need. The details of file formats, schedules and mappings will be agreed with them in due course.

4. Implementation Approach

We use an agile approach with weekly demos to keep things moving quickly. Requirements will be gathered in the first two weeks through a small number of workshops with the Board's team. The developers will then configure and customise QuickBill in short cycles, showing progress every week.

- Weekly demonstration call with the Board's project contact.
- Requirements captured as simple user stories in a shared tracker.
- Issues fixed as they are found; no heavy documentation.
- A short handover note at the end of the project.

Team: 1 project lead and 4 developers. Testing will be done by the developers. Data migration will be handled by the Board's IT team with our guidance.

Our way of working

At BrightPath we practise agile ways of working. Agile means that we deliver in small steps, learn from feedback and adapt quickly. We believe this is the best way to build software in a world that changes fast. Our teams are self-organising, empowered to make decisions and focused on delivering value.

Principle	How we practise it
Customer collaboration	A weekly demonstration and a shared messaging channel with the Board
Working software	We show running screens, not long documents
Responding to change	Requirements can change at any time and we adapt
Continuous improvement	A short retrospective after every cycle
Transparency	A shared board showing what is to do, in progress and done

Best practices we follow

- We follow industry best practices for software development wherever practical.
- We try to write clean, readable and maintainable configuration.
- We use version control for our work.
- We believe in testing early and testing often.
- We aim to communicate clearly, openly and respectfully.
- We strive to deliver a great experience for every user.

Project governance

The project lead will be the Board's main contact and will provide regular updates. A steering meeting can be held whenever the Board wishes. Reports are provided on request. Risks and issues will be discussed in the weekly call and addressed quickly.

Training and handover

We provide two training sessions in the price. Sessions are delivered online or in person, subject to travel arrangements, and include a short presentation, a demonstration and time for questions. A handover note summarising how the system is set up will be provided at the end of the project. Additional training can be arranged at an additional fee.

Data migration

The Board's IT team will extract existing customer data and provide it to us in a spreadsheet or file format. We will provide guidance on how the data should be organised. The Board will need to check the data after it has been loaded. We have not yet seen the structure or volume of the Board's data, so the effort needed for migration cannot be estimated precisely at this stage.

5. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

Stage	Weeks
Setup and configuration	1-4
Customisation	5-11
Testing	12-14
Go-live	15-16

The timeline is aggressive but achievable because the team is small and decisions can be made quickly. Milestones will be shared with the Board during the project. If the Board needs changes to the plan, we will adjust as we go.

Role	Number
Project lead	1
Developers	4

How we plan

Our plan is deliberately lightweight, because we believe that heavy plans slow teams down. The stages in the table above give a general view of how the project will flow. Exact tasks will be organised week by week in consultation with the Board. If something takes longer than expected we will work extra hours to stay on track, and we will keep the Board informed.

Week	What the Board can expect
Week 2	A first look at the new screens
Week 6	Demonstration of billing and the customer portal
Week 10	Demonstration of payments
Week 14	Testing support from the Board's users
Week 16	Go-live

We accept that the plan is ambitious. The Board's quick decisions and availability will help us deliver on time.

Roles and responsibilities

Who	What they do
Project lead (BrightPath)	Talks to the Board, plans the weeks, keeps the team on track
Developers (BrightPath)	Configure QuickBill, build screens, fix problems, run tests
Board project contact	Provides information, attends weekly demo, approves changes
Board IT team	Provides data, finance file formats and test accounts
Board business users	Try the system and share feedback

We have found that clear, friendly communication is the best way to avoid misunderstandings. Where tasks depend on the Board, we will remind the project contact in the weekly call.

6. Commercial Proposal and Price Table

Item	Price (INR)
Implementation and customisation	2,40,00,000
QuickBill licence (3 years)	3,60,00,000
Training (2 sessions)	4,00,000
Total 3-year cost	6,04,00,000

Prices are indicative and may change after detailed requirements are confirmed. Hosting costs are not included.

Payment terms: 50 percent on contract signature and 50 percent on go-live. The licence is invoiced annually in advance. Additional work requested by the Board will be quoted separately.

We believe this is the best value offer for the Board because we keep our overheads low and use our own platform rather than expensive third-party products.

Why our price is lower

We are often asked how we can offer such competitive prices. The answer is that we are a lean company with low overheads, we do not maintain expensive offices or large sales teams, and we focus on our own platform so that we do not pay licence fees to other vendors. We pass these savings on to our clients.

Price element	Comment
Implementation and customisation	Based on our estimate of the effort needed; may change when requirements are confirmed
QuickBill licence	Three-year licence; renewal terms to be discussed
Training	Two sessions; further sessions on request
Hosting	Not included; cost depends on the size of the server chosen
Changes after contract	Quoted separately at our standard rates

Our pricing is designed to be easy to understand. We do not charge for ideas, and we will always try to be fair with any additional requests.

7. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

We take security seriously. Data is protected by passwords and the cloud provider's standard firewall. We are planning to begin ISO 27001 certification next year. We will follow applicable data protection laws.

Area	Our approach
Access	User names and passwords
Network	Cloud provider's standard firewall
Certification	ISO 27001 planned
Data protection	We will follow applicable laws

Risks will be managed by the project lead as they arise.

Our commitment to security

Security is important to everyone at BrightPath. We believe that protecting customer information is the right thing to do, and we aim to follow good practices wherever we can. Our team is aware of common online threats, and we try to keep our software up to date. As a growing company we intend to strengthen our security programme over time, including the formal certification mentioned above.

We will discuss specific security requirements with the Board after contract award and will do our best to meet them within the time and budget available.

8. Support Model and Service Levels

Support is available Monday to Friday, 9 am to 6 pm, by email. We aim to respond within one business day.

Urgent problems can be raised by phone to the project lead during working hours. Fixes will be provided as quickly as possible. We do not currently offer a formal service level agreement, but we can discuss this if needed.

Our service philosophy

We believe great support is about people, not processes. Our team is friendly, approachable and eager to help. After go-live we will remain in close touch with the Board's team through email and messaging, and we will do our best to resolve questions as quickly as we can. If a serious problem occurs outside working hours we will try to respond when possible.

Support item	Provision
Hours	Monday to Friday, 9 am to 6 pm
Channel	Email, with phone to the project lead in working hours
Response	We aim to respond within one business day
Formal SLA	Not currently offered; can be discussed
Warranty	Defects found shortly after go-live will be fixed

Continuous improvement after go-live

After go-live we hope to hold regular conversations with the Board about how the platform is performing and what could be improved. Suggestions will be collected and considered for future updates. New features may be added from time to time, and the Board is welcome to benefit from improvements that we make for other clients. Updates will be applied when convenient and we will let the Board know in advance where possible.

9. Relevant Experience and References

We have delivered 3 web portals for retail and education clients. This would be our first utility billing project. References can be provided on request.

Past project (fictional)	Type	Year
BookNest Retail	E-commerce portal	2023
Learnwell Academy	Student portal	2024
Fresh Basket Stores	Online ordering portal	2025

About our past work

We are proud of the portals we have built. BookNest Retail launched a new online shop with our help and was delighted by the result. Learnwell Academy now has a student portal that students enjoy using. Fresh Basket Stores wanted an easy way for customers to order groceries online, and we delivered it in a few weeks. These projects taught us a great deal about building customer-friendly web experiences, and we are eager to apply that learning to the water sector.

We recognise that the Board is a public utility with different needs from our previous clients. This would be our first utility billing project. We are keen to learn about the water sector and we are confident that our enthusiasm and quick learning will bring success.

We understand that the Board may like to speak to our clients. We would be happy to discuss references with the Board at a suitable time.

10. Assumptions and Exclusions

- The Board provides clear requirements in the first two weeks.
- The Board's IT team performs data migration and provides test data.
- Hosting costs, SMS charges and payment gateway fees are not included.
- Any integration other than the finance file export is out of scope until agreed.
- Prices exclude GST.

Notes on the proposal

This proposal reflects our understanding of the Board's needs based on the information in the RFP. Where the RFP is silent we have made reasonable assumptions in the interest of keeping the price low. We would be happy to review any assumption with the Board during clarification meetings. Items not mentioned in this proposal are not included. Optional extras, such as additional languages, extra reports and further integrations, can be added for an additional price once their size is understood.

We want to be a good partner to the Board. If, at any point, the Board feels that the project is not going as planned, we would welcome an open conversation.

11. Appendices

Appendix A: Team

Name (fictional)	Role	Background
Arjun Rao	Project lead	8 years in web projects; founder of BrightPath
Developers (4)	Developers	Web and low-code developers with 2-5 years of experience

Appendix B: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Low-code	A way of building software using configuration with little coding
Portal	Website where customers log in
ISO 27001	An international information security standard

Appendix C: Meet the team

Name (fictional)	Role	Background
Arjun Rao	Founder and project lead	Studied computer applications; started BrightPath in 2022; enjoys cricket and hiking; loves solving problems with simple tools
Sana Qureshi	Senior developer	5 years of web development; built portals for retail clients; enthusiastic about user experience design
Kiran Babu	Developer	3 years of experience; works on payment pages and forms; keen learner of new frameworks
Pooja Nair	Developer	3 years of experience; focuses on mobile layouts and styling; passionate about accessibility
Dev Malhotra	Developer	2 years of experience; supports portal features and testing; interested in data visualisation

Appendix D: Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Can you really finish in 16 weeks?	Yes. We are a small, focused team and we believe in moving fast.
Is QuickBill used by other water boards?	QuickBill is a new platform and is evolving every month with feedback from our clients.
What happens if requirements change?	We welcome change. Changes may affect price and timing and will be discussed.
Will our data be safe?	We take data protection seriously and will follow applicable laws.
Do you offer 24x7 support?	Our standard support hours are Monday to Friday. Other arrangements can be discussed.
Can you integrate with our other systems?	Probably. We will look at this after the contract is signed.
Who owns the software?	BrightPath owns QuickBill; the Board receives a licence for the term.

Appendix E: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Agile	A flexible way of running projects in short cycles
API	A way for two systems to talk to each other
Cloud	Computers accessed over the internet
Customisation	Changing a product to suit a client

Term	Meaning
UX	User experience; how pleasant a product is to use
Go-live	The day the system starts being used for real

Appendix F: General terms and conditions (summary)

- Services are provided on the basis of the proposal and the requirements known at the date of this proposal.
- Timelines depend on timely feedback, approvals and content from the Board; delays may extend the schedule.
- BrightPath retains ownership of QuickBill, its templates, tools and methods. The Board receives a non-exclusive licence for the term.
- Liability of BrightPath is limited to the fees paid in the preceding twelve months, to the extent permitted by law.
- Neither party is liable for events beyond its reasonable control, including cloud provider outages.
- Either party may terminate with 30 days' written notice; fees for work completed are payable.
- Invoices are payable within 15 days. Late payments may incur interest.
- Confidential information will be protected with reasonable care.
- These terms may be updated by agreement in writing.

Appendix G: Our commitment to sustainability

As a young company we care about the future. We encourage a paperless office, we choose cloud services that describe themselves as environmentally conscious, and we support our team to work flexibly. We hope to formalise our sustainability goals as we grow and to share progress with our clients.

Appendix H: What clients say about working with us

We are fortunate to receive kind words from the clients we have worked with. One retail client described the team as responsive and fun to work with. An education client said the portal exceeded expectations. A services client appreciated that we always picked up the phone. We treasure this feedback and use it to keep improving.

Appendix I: Our approach to quality

Quality matters to us. We try to review each other's work, we test screens on different devices and we invite clients to try the product early. We believe that quality is a habit rather than a department, and we hope to build more formal quality practices as our team grows. Over time we would like to introduce checklists, automated tests and regular quality reviews.

Quality activity	Current practice
Peer review	Developers look at each other's work when time allows
Testing	Developers test their own screens and fix problems found
User feedback	Collected in the weekly demonstration
Defect tracking	Simple shared list
Improvement	Short team discussion after each cycle

Appendix J: A note on the water sector

Water is precious, and we are inspired by the Board's mission to deliver a safe and reliable supply to the region. We have started reading about utility billing, tariff structures and customer service in the water sector, and we look forward to learning directly from the Board's experts. We believe that fresh eyes can bring new ideas and that an open, curious attitude is the best way to learn. We are excited by the opportunity to support the Board's customers with a more convenient digital experience.

Appendix K: Communication plan

Channel	Purpose	Frequency
Weekly demonstration call	Show progress and gather feedback	Weekly
Messaging group	Quick questions and updates	Daily as needed
Email summary	Record decisions	After each call
Shared tracker	Show tasks and status	Always available
Steering meeting	Review progress with senior stakeholders	On request

Appendix L: Next steps

If the Board is interested in our proposal, we would be delighted to arrange a friendly introductory call and a short online demonstration of QuickBill. We could then hold a brief workshop to talk about the Board's priorities and to sketch the first screens together. After that, we can prepare a refined plan and a final price for discussion. We look forward to hearing from the Board and to the possibility of working together.

Step	Suggested timing
Introductory call	Within a few days of the Board's response
Demonstration of QuickBill	Following week
Requirements workshop	Within two weeks
Refined plan and price	Shortly after the workshop
Contract signature and kick-off	As soon as the Board is ready

Appendix M: Contact

Arjun Rao, Founder and Project Lead, BrightPath Tech LLP, Hyderabad. Email and phone details are available on request. We aim to respond to enquiries on the same day.

Appendix N: Closing thoughts

We know that choosing a partner for a project of this importance is not easy. We hope that this proposal has given the Board a sense of who we are: an energetic, friendly and ambitious team with a genuine wish to help. We are not the biggest company, and we do not claim to know everything, but we are quick learners and we care deeply about our clients' success. Thank you for taking the time to consider BrightPath Tech.

End of proposal. This is a fictional proposal created for a classroom exercise; all organisations, people and figures are invented.